Cecilia Ndethya Musyoka

Project & Grants Accountant | Financial Reporting • Donor Audits • Budgeting & Controls

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SUMMARY

Resourceful and ethically-driven accountant with over 10 years of professional experience in financial reporting, donor-funded project accounting, and institutional budgeting within research and public-sector environments. Proven ability to manage multi-million–shilling projects, deliver IFRS-compliant financial statements, and strengthen financial controls and grant compliance. Adept at working with cross-functional teams (researchers, procurement, and auditors) to ensure timely, accurate reporting and efficient use of funds. Committed to continuous learning and digital transformation in finance (including adoption of modern accounting systems and good financial grant practice).

COMPETENCIES

- **Financial Reporting**: Preparing, analyzing and interpreting financial statements in accordance with IFRS, IPSAS, GAAP and relevant local standards (including familiarity with IFRS 18 — Presentation & Disclosure, IPSAS 1 — Presentation of Financial Statements).
- **Donor Fund Accounting & Grants Management**: Accounting, reporting and compliance for donor-funded projects; preparation of quarterly donor project reports and audit support.
- **Accounting Systems & Processes**: Proficient with QuickBooks, SAP and ERP platforms; experience with posting payments, approvals, reconciliations and report production.
- **Budgeting, Forecasting & Cost/Management Accounting**: Institutional budgeting (recurrent, internal grants and development), cost control, variance analysis and decision-support.
- **Internal Controls, Audit & Assurance**: Planning and conducting internal and external audits, risk assessment, compliance reviews and preparation of audit schedules.
- **Cash & Treasury Management**: Bank reconciliations, cash office management, petty cash, imprest administration and treasury controls.
- **Regulatory Compliance & Taxation**: Knowledge of Kenyan tax laws (PAYE, withholding tax), filing statutory returns and corporate governance requirements.
- **Project Accounting & Project Management Support**: Hands-on management of large-scale GOK and donor projects, budget monitoring and collaboration with researchers for workplans.
- **Systems & Continuous Learning**: Commitment to digital transformation, AI applications, data security and privacy; continuous professional development.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND MEMBERSHIP

- Member of **Institute of Certified Public Accountants of Kenya (ICPAK)** Membership number **35573**
- Successfully led the Institute's **Good Financial and Grants Practice (GFGP) Silver accreditation** process as team lead.
- Developed **Quality Management System Standard Operating Procedures** for the Accounts Department at IPR, in compliance with **ISO 9001:2008** standards.
- Honored as **Employee of the Year – Accounts Department** for two consecutive years (2018 & 2019).

EXPERIENCE

Kenya Institute of Primate Research — Finance / Project Accountant
2018 – Present

Key responsibilities

- Prepare financial statements and management reports in accordance with International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS).
- Perform bank reconciliations; post receipts and payments to cashbooks; prepare quarterly income & expenditure reports and project statements.
- Lead budgeting, forecasting and ongoing budget monitoring; assist Deputy Director Finance with annual budget preparation and risk assessments.
- Provide financial inputs to institutional yearly work plans in collaboration with research teams.
- Prepare payment vouchers, process online payments and cheques; review and sign DOFs and LPOs to ensure correct costing, vendor pricing and fund availability.
- Maintain imprest register, verify imprest surrenders and prepare related journals.
- Manage cash office operations (withdrawals, deposits, petty cash) and reconcile cashbooks.
- Process and file statutory returns; issue official receipts; reconcile creditors' ledger accounts and safeguard accountable documents (cheque books, receipt books).
- Respond to audit queries and provide audit support documentation in coordination with the Deputy Director Finance.

Grants & donor-funded projects

- Served as Project Accountant on LSTM-funded Snake Antivenom projects (2018–2022) and (2021–2025), providing full accounting and reporting support.
- Audit & compliance: audit donor-funded projects to ensure transactions meet donor terms; prepare quarterly donor financial reports; assist scientists with budget preparation and monitoring to align technical and financial needs with donor requirements.
- Coordinate donor audit responses and supply required documentation.

Government-funded projects

- Manage financial activities for Government of Kenya-funded programs.
- Support financial control, reporting and audit responses for large institutional projects.

Project management & cross-functional support

- Provide financial oversight for project planning, monitoring and risk assessment; collaborate closely with researchers and technical teams to align budgets and workplans.

ATTACHMENTS

University of Nairobi — Administration & Records (Feb 2016 – Aug 2016)

- Document control, filing, minute-taking and administrative support.

Kenya Civil Aviation Authority — Records & Administration (June 2013 – Aug 2013)

- Filing, registers maintenance and clerical support.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Finance - (2022 - 2026)

- Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology (JKUAT).

Bachelor of Commerce (Finance option) - (2013- 2016)

- Mount Kenya University (MKU).

Diploma in Business Management - (2011- 2013)

- Mount Kenya University (MKU).

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Public Accountant - **CPA K Certification** (April 2025)
- Certified Public Accountant - **CPA Part I–VI** (2019 – 2025)
- Grants Management Course — Strathmore University (2021)
- Good Financial Grant Practice (GFGP) — African Academy of Sciences (2020)
- Research Administration & Management Training Program — Rwanda (2024)

REFEREES

- **Geoffrey Namachanja** — Financial Controller, National Museums of Kenya
  Email: geoffrey.namachanja@gmail.com | gnamachanja@museums.or.ke

- **Dr. Danson Mwangi** — Director, Capacity Building, Partnership & Grants Management, Kenya Institute of Primate Research
  Email: mwangikareri@primateresearch.org

- **Dr. Atunga Nyachieo** — Director, Research & Productivity Development, Kenya Institute of Primate Research
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